

Styling Contract

General Style

Use a Breaking Bad-inspired dark green interface, cream text, and muted yellow actions. Preserve the approved stories.

Store global styles in `client/css/index.css`, imported as `../css/index.css` from `client/src/main.tsx`. Do not create `App.css`.

Paths below define the planned implementation locations. Use centered panels, a responsive puzzle-card list, and one gameplay layout for every stage. Implement components when their development tasks are assigned; this contract is the shared styling reference.

Color Palette

Name	Value	Use
Page	#071B12	Full-page background
Panel	#102B1C	Header, footer, and page panels
Card	#173B27	Puzzle cards, clue cards, and message surfaces
Input	#0B2116	Answer input
Text	#F2EAD5	Cream headings and body text
Secondary	#C5CDB7	Supporting text and metadata
Border	#557A5F	Panel/card/input borders
Accent	#D4BE69	Primary actions, active navigation, hints, focus
Accent hover	#E1CE83	Hovered primary actions
Action text	#102016	Text on yellow action backgrounds
Success	#A3D9A5	Correct-answer feedback and completion
Error	#F2A6A0	Wrong answers, request errors, exhausted hints
Disabled background	#263E2E	Disabled controls and unavailable cards
Disabled text	#A7B4A7	Disabled control text

Use the named colors consistently; literal hex values in plain CSS match the reference syntax. For transparent elements, background is not applicable. For borderless elements, border is not applicable.

Typography

Use one system-font stack throughout: `-apple-system`, `BlinkMacSystemFont`, `"Segoe UI"`, `Roboto`, `sans-serif`. Headings and action labels use bold weight; body text uses regular weight. Inputs and buttons inherit the font. No font installation or external font service is needed.

Use descriptive classes such as `puzzle-card-title`, without requiring double-underscore naming. State classes follow the reference: `nav-link-active`, `success`, `error`, and `disabled`. Show feedback in words as well as colors. Keep keyboard focus visible with Accent; disabled controls use the disabled palette rather than color-only meaning.

Shared Components

Page Layout

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Shared header, main area, and footer	client/src/App.tsx	page	All	Page	Text	Border: not applicable; accent: not applicable

Use `main-layout` for the main content. Page sections use `panel` with page-specific classes. Keep normal scrolling for long clues; stack cards and form controls on small screens.

Navbar

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Project title and Mysteries / How to Play links	client/src/components/Navbar.tsx	navbar	All	Panel	Text; inactive links: Secondary	Border; active/hover links: Accent

Use `nav-link` and `nav-link-active` with `NavLink`, following the teacher's pattern. No API status or development diagnostics in the player-facing header.

Footer

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Short project/team label	client/src/components/Footer.tsx	footer	All	Panel	Secondary	Border; accent: not applicable

Action Button Styles

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Investigate, submit, retry, and return actions	client/css/index.css	action-button	All	Accent; hover: Accent hover	Action text	Border: not applicable; focus: Accent

Use these shared CSS classes on buttons and action links. Disabled controls use Disabled background, Disabled text, and Border. Secondary actions use Panel, Text, and Border with Accent on hover/focus.

Loading Message

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Explain an in-flight data request	client/src/components/LoadingMessage.tsx	message	Selection, gameplay, result	Card	Secondary	Border; accent: not applicable

Error Message

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Explain a failed request and offer retry	client/src/components/ErrorMessage.tsx	message error	Selection, gameplay, result	Card	Error	Error border; retry uses Action Button Styles

Empty State

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Explain an empty puzzle list	client/src/components/EmptyState.tsx	empty-state	Selection	Not applicable	Secondary	Border: not applicable; accent: not applicable

Pages

Mystery Selection Page

Puzzles Section

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Heading, short introduction, and API-driven puzzle list	client/src/components/PuzzlesSection.tsx	panel puzzles-panel	Selection	Panel	Text; introduction: Secondary	Border; accent: not applicable

client/src/pages/PuzzlesPage.tsx is a thin wrapper. Reuse Navbar, Footer, Loading Message, Error Message, and Empty State.

Puzzle List

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Arrange the three puzzle cards	client/src/components/PuzzleList.tsx	puzzle-list	Selection	Not applicable	Inherited Text	Border: not applicable; accent: not applicable

Puzzle Card

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Puzzle title, summary, stage count, and Investigate link	client/src/components/PuzzleCard.tsx	puzzle-card	Selection	Card	Title: Text; summary/metadata: Secondary	Border; action: Accent

Use puzzle-card-title, puzzle-card-summary, and puzzle-card-footer. Investigate uses Action Button Styles. If an unavailable card is used later, use Disabled background/text, Border, a disabled control, and clear unavailable wording. Display durations and difficulty ratings only if supplied in the agreed data. A coming-soon card is optional.

How to Play Page

Instructions

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Explain selection, clues, answers, hints, stage order, and completion	client/src/pages/HowToPlayPage.tsx	panel how-to-play-page	How to Play	Panel	Text; supporting text: Secondary	Border; numbered steps: Accent

Use an ordered list with instruction-list and instruction-step. Reuse Navbar, Footer, and Action Button Styles for a return-to-puzzles link. Hint limits and progress behavior must match the implemented API.

Gameplay Page

Puzzle Section

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Puzzle title, opening story, current stage, and player actions	client/src/components/PuzzleSection.tsx	panel puzzle-panel	Gameplay	Panel	Text; supporting text: Secondary	Border; opening story marker: Accent

client/src/pages/PuzzlePage.tsx is a thin wrapper for the dynamic puzzle route. Use puzzle-story for the introduction. Reuse Navbar, Footer, Loading Message, and Error Message. One section handles all three stages and their feedback states.

Stage Heading

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Current stage title, question, and stage number	client/src/components/StageHeading.tsx	stage-heading	Gameplay	Not applicable	Title/question: Text; count: Secondary	Border: not applicable; progress accent: Accent

Clue List and Cards

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Render current-stage clues	client/src/components/ClueList.tsx	clue-list	Gameplay	Not applicable	Inherited Text	Border: not applicable; accent: not applicable
Display one clue	client/src/components/ClueCard.tsx	clue-card	Gameplay	Card	Text; clue number: Secondary	Border; accent: not applicable

Use plain inner classes such as clue-card-title and clue-card-text if needed. Clue wording comes from the agreed data; do not invent evidence titles that change its meaning.

Answer Form

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Labeled answer field and Submit action	client/src/components/AnswerForm.tsx	answer-form	Gameplay	Form: not applicable; input: Input	Text; placeholder: Secondary	Input: Border; focus/action: Accent

Use answer-input and Action Button Styles. Disable submission while empty or pending, with disabled colors and explanatory button text. Keep the input available after request failure. Exact spacing and responsive sizing can be defined during implementation.

Answer Feedback

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Explain correct or wrong answers	<code>client/src/components/AnswerFeedback.tsx</code>	<code>answer-feedback</code>	Gameplay	Card	Correct; Success; wrong; Error	Correct: Success border; wrong: Error border

Add `success` or `error` to the root class. Use clear words, not color alone. A wrong answer keeps the player on the same stage.

Hint Panel

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Request/display allowed hints and explain exhaustion	<code>client/src/components/HintPanel.tsx</code>	<code>hint-panel</code>	Gameplay	Card	Hint: Accent; supporting text: Secondary; errors: Error	Border; hint marker: Accent

Reuse Action Button Styles. Pending/exhausted actions use disabled colors and visible text. Keep a way to request the next allowed hint. Reset stage-specific display when the server advances the stage.

Result / Reveal Page

Puzzle Result

Purpose	Proposed file path	Root className	Pages	Background	Text	Border / accent
Show puzzle title, completion, final reveal, and return navigation	<code>client/src/pages/ResultPage.tsx</code>	<code>panel result-page</code>	Result / reveal	Panel	Heading/reveal: Text; supporting text: Secondary	Border; completion: Success; return action: Accent

Reuse Navbar, Footer, Loading Message, Error Message, and Action Button Styles. Show the actual final reveal only after the server confirms completion. The completion badge can be a `case-closed` element inside this page; it does not require another component file. No score, timer, replay, or statistics are required.

Agreement and Contributions

- **Majed:** selected the theme and conventions, reviewed this contract, and approved it as the team's styling reference.
- **Preparation:** Majed with assistant support, using the handed task and teacher client reference.
- **Yazan and Badr:** recipients of this contract for review and use during their assigned frontend work. Their agreement or authorship is not claimed here.

Use the same colors, classes, and shared components across pages. Discuss changes to this contract with Majed before implementation.